

CAPITAL YOUTH EXPO • COMPETITION RULEBOOK
No. 12 • LITERARY & MIND SPORTS

Debate Competition

A structured debate where teams argue for or against a motion, judged on argumentation, rebuttal strength, and delivery.

Rules & Specifications

Team Composition	Teams of 2 members each, competing as Proposition (For) or Opposition (Against).
Format	Motions are announced 30 minutes before each round (limited preparation time, no internet access during prep). First member of each team will deliver information within 5 minutes and 2 nd member will counter the speech of opponents in 5 minutes.
Speaking Time	Each speaker gets 5 minutes; a warning bell rings at 4 minutes and a final bell at 5 minutes. Points of Information may be offered between the 1st and 4th minute.
Rounds	Preliminary rounds are held on a points/ranking basis; top teams advance to semi-finals and the grand final on pre-announced or impromptu motions.
Judging Criteria	• Matter (Argument Quality & Evidence) — 40% • Manner (Delivery & Persuasion) — 30% • Method (Structure & Rebuttal) — 30%
Conduct & Penalties	Personal attacks, use of offensive language, or exceeding speaking time results in point deductions or disqualification for that round.

General Rules — Applicable to This Category

- Strict Punctuality — Teams must report to their arena, lab, stage, or table 15 minutes before their scheduled heat or session. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.
- Code of Conduct — Abusive behavior, argument with judges, leads to immediate disqualification.
- Content & Decorum — Content must remain free of hate speech, personal attacks on individuals or political parties, and any offensive or discriminatory material; violations result in point deductions or disqualification.
- Judge's Decision — The decision of the technical panel, head referees, and judges is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee and apply alongside the master rulebook. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.